



GRASSHOPPERS

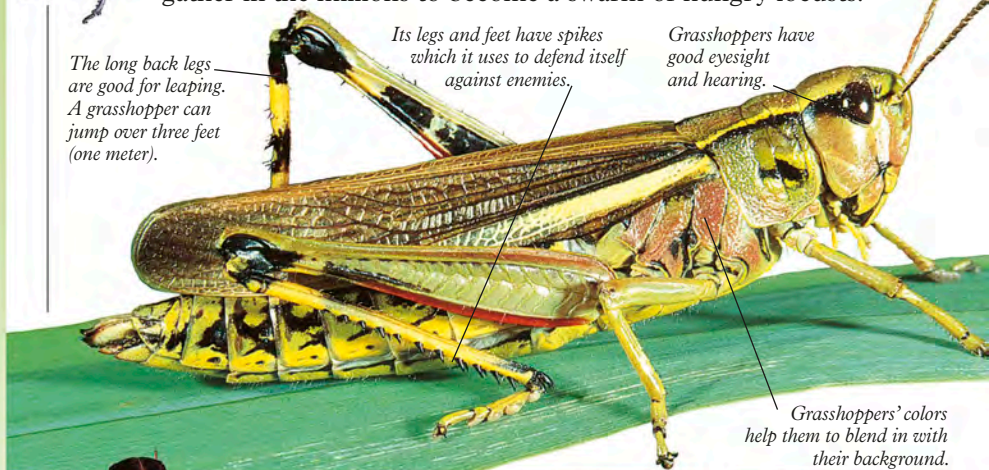


Grasshoppers are known for the “ticking” sounds they make and for their ability to leap high into the air. There are more than 20,000 different kinds of grasshoppers in the world. Grasshoppers are plant-eaters, feeding on leaves and stems. Normally, they live alone. But under special conditions, some species undergo a series of physical changes. They increase in size, become more brightly colored, and gather in the millions to become a swarm of hungry locusts.

The long back legs are good for leaping. A grasshopper can jump over three feet (one meter).

Its legs and feet have spikes which it uses to defend itself against enemies.

Grasshoppers have good eyesight and hearing.



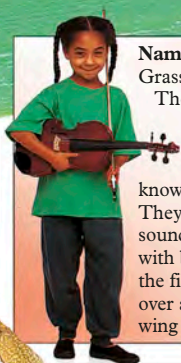
Grasshoppers' colors help them to blend in with their background.

Name that tune

Grasshoppers are good fiddle players.

They make music the same way a violin produces sound. The grasshopper's leg is its bow and the tough wing vein is the string. Crickets are also known for their musical ability.

They use their wings to make sounds. One wing has a thick vein with bumps on it. This is called the file. The cricket rubs the file over a rough ridge on the other wing to make cricket music.



Chirping cousins

Crickets belong to the same insect group as grasshoppers, but crickets have longer antennae and like eating other insects.

